Snap

These snappy-looking creatures are large, intelligent reptiles that are well-adapted to life in the water. *Crocodilians* all have similar features, but there are some interesting differences, too.



The strange bump on a male's snout is called a ghara.



A gharial's teeth are all the same size and shape.

Air conditioning

A crocodile uses various tricks to control its body temperature. On a hot day, it can cool down by raising its head and opening its mouth – or by crawling away into the shade or into water.

Crocodiles are more closely related to birds than to other reptiles.

Nile crocodile



Snack attack

All *Crocodilian* reptiles are meat-eaters (carnivores). Even the larger crocs and gators are quick and strong enough to launch themselves out of the water – straight up into the air like a rocket – and snatch their prey.